PATIN / TERO!

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT | SECTION 1 — GAME OVERVIEW

Consolidated reconstruction based on the previously discussed game concept; not a verbatim copy of the original Section 1.

1.1 Game Concept

PATIN / TERO! is a deterministic, grid-based strategy auto-battler inspired by the traditional Filipino street game Patintero.

Players build a team of runners and guards, arrange their formations, and program their movements using predefined command cards.

Once both players finalize their strategies, the battle executes automatically. Victory depends on strategic positioning, movement prediction, team composition, and effective command sequencing rather than real-time reflexes.

1.2 Game Genre

Category	Description
Genre	Strategy / Auto-Battler
Subgenre	Deterministic, Grid-Based Tactical Strategy
Inspiration	Filipino Patintero
Perspective	Slightly isometric 3D
Game Mode	Competitive multiplayer
Primary Platform	Windows PC
Input	Mouse and keyboard
Orientation	Landscape

1.3 Core Gameplay Premise

Each player simultaneously manages two separate 4 × 8 arenas.

Offense Arena: Three runners attempt to cross the opponent’s defensive lines, reach the opposite end of the grid, and return safely to their starting side.

Defense Arena: Four guards patrol predefined lines and attempt to intercept the opponent’s runners.

Players determine their strategies during the planning phase by selecting characters, positioning units at valid starting points, and assigning movement cards. During battle, all units execute their programmed commands automatically.

1.4 Core Design Pillars

Strategic Prediction: Players must anticipate opposing movement patterns and create effective combinations of runner and guard programs.

Deterministic Gameplay: Identical initial conditions and commands produce identical outcomes. Strategy and timing determine the result.

Accessible but Deep: Simple movement commands and clear grid-based rules create an approachable experience with substantial tactical possibilities.

Filipino Cultural Identity: The game reimagines Patintero as a modern competitive strategy experience while preserving its fundamental runner-versus-guard identity.

Adaptation and Progression: Players improve their teams through character purchases, upgrades, moveset combinations, and strategic adjustments between battles.

1.5 Player Experience

The intended player experience follows three core actions: Plan → Watch → Adapt.

Players develop a strategy, observe its execution, identify weaknesses, and improve their next formation. The excitement comes from watching carefully constructed plans succeed—or discovering how an opponent outsmarted them.

1.6 Unique Selling Points

- Filipino street-game mechanics reimagined as a competitive auto-battler.
- Two simultaneous arenas requiring offensive and defensive planning.
- Deterministic movement based on programmed command cards.
- Character-specific movesets and upgradeable units.
- Tactical gameplay emphasizing prediction rather than reflexes.
- Tournament-based progression and elimination.